Financial Assistance for Vet Bills

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These organizations may help pay for veterinary care. Most have their own rules about who qualifies, so read each one's requirements before you apply. Many require a diagnosis and cost estimate from your vet.

The SPCA of Tompkins County has no affiliation with these organizations and does not endorse them. We share this list to give pet owners options. Please do your own research before applying.

Paying over time

Ask your vet whether they accept these before you apply.

Option	What it is
CareCredit	A health care credit card with flexible financing, so you can pay over time
Scratchpay	Payment plans of 6 to 24 months, for $150 to $10,000

Crowdfunding lets friends, family and strangers donate toward your pet's care:

- Waggle: made for pets in medical crisis
- GoFundMe
- FundRazr
- GoGetFunding

Grants for emergency and life-threatening care

Most of these groups help only when a pet's life is in danger and the pet is expected to recover with treatment.

Organization	What it helps with	Good to know
Banfield Foundation	Immediately life-threatening conditions	Income-qualified
Bow Wow Buddies	Emergency services and serious conditions	Also listed under illness and ongoing care
Brown Dog Foundation	Sick pets likely to respond to treatment	Pets in immediate danger come first; other cases considered
For the Love of Alex	Emergency and lifesaving care	Low-income households
Frankie's Friends	Lifesaving emergency or specialty care	Needs a good prognosis and proof of financial need
Friends Rescued	Emergency and specialty care	
Hope Mending Hearts	Life-threatening injury or illness that needs urgent care	Also helps domestic violence survivors and deploying soldiers
J. Kirk Foundation	Emergency vet costs up to $200	Also emergency food or supplies up to $100
Oscar's Cause	Emergency and non-emergency care	
Pet Assistance, Inc.	Urgent or life-threatening emergencies only	Owner must pay part of the cost
RedRover Relief Urgent Care Grants	Life-threatening injury or illness	Household income under $60,000; needs a good prognosis
Violet's Friends	Urgent or critical care, surgery, therapy, mobility aids	Needs a good or long-term prognosis

Grants for illness, injury and ongoing care

For care that isn't an emergency, such as chronic illness, medications, or surgery that can be planned ahead.

Organization	What it helps with	Good to know
Friends & Vets Helping Pets	Curable conditions such as tumors, broken bones, expensive medication, and post-surgery prosthetics or carts	For lifesaving care, not care that only prolongs life
Help-A-Pet	Vet services, medicine and medical supplies for sick or injured pets	
Loving Hearts 4 Paws	Vet bills you can't afford	
The Mosby Foundation	Critically sick, injured, abused or neglected dogs	Dogs only. Does not cover diagnostics, tests, CT scans or x-rays.
Onyx & Breezy Foundation	Many kinds of medical hardship	You must apply for CareCredit first and send proof of approval or denial
Paws 4 A Cure	Non-routine care for illness and injury, including medication, insulin, heartworm treatment, dental problems, and wheelchairs	
The Pet Fund	Non-urgent, non-basic care such as cancer, heart disease, chronic conditions, diabetes and eye disease	
Pet Lifeline Program	Non-urgent, non-basic care such as cancer, heart disease, diabetes, eye disease and IBD	
Shamrock Animal Fund	Vet care for owners with limited income	Syracuse and Central New York
STA Relief	Medical care and emergency boarding	

Also covers non-urgent care: Bow Wow Buddies, Brown Dog Foundation, Friends Rescued, and Oscar's Cause (see the emergency section above).

Help for specific conditions

Condition	Organizations
Cancer	Live Like Roo · Magic Bullet Fund (surgery or chemotherapy only; not palliative care or euthanasia) · The Perseus Foundation · The Pet Fund and Pet Lifeline (above) · Veterinary Cancer Society's full list
Diabetes	DCIN One-Time Assistance (glucose testing kit and a few months of insulin, or up to $150 back) · DCIN Compassionate Assistance (ongoing insulin, testing supplies and limited vet care for low-income caregivers) · Paws 4 A Cure (above)
Heartworm	Paws 4 A Cure (above)
Amputation	Tripawds Amputation Surgery Assistance
Senior pets	Frosted Faces Foundation: vet care plus food, supplies, training, grooming, pet deposits, fence repairs and impound fees
Vaccine-associated sarcoma (cats)	FVEAP: only for cats with vaccine-associated or injection-site sarcoma
Wheelchairs, prosthetics and medical supplies	HandicappedPets.org (wheelchair donations only, no financial aid) · Walkin' Pets list of aid groups · Friends & Vets Helping Pets, Help-A-Pet and Paws 4 A Cure (above)

Help for specific groups of people

Who	Organizations
People experiencing homelessness	Street Dog Coalition – Ithaca (free monthly clinic) · Pets of the Homeless (emergency care, wellness clinics, food and supplies)
Ithaca families with low incomes	Southside Healthy Pet Clinic ($20 wellness visits)
Veterans and military	Pets for Patriots (hardship help for veterans with adopted pets) · Dogs on Deployment (emergency care, travel, spay/neuter or boarding during deployment) · PACT for Animals (free long-term foster care during deployment, training or a long hospital stay) · Hope Mending Hearts (above)
Domestic violence survivors	RedRover Relief Safe Escape Grants (mainly pet boarding while you're in a shelter) · Banfield Foundation and Hope Mending Hearts (above). Locally, call **The Advocacy Center** 24/7 at (607) 277-5000.
People with disabilities and service dogs	IAADP Veterinary Care Partnership (sudden, treatable illness or injury in an assistance dog; your vet must apply) · Land of Pure Gold Foundation (up to $1,000 for working dog cancer treatment) · Assistance Dog United Campaign (help paying for a service dog), info@assistancedogunitedcampaign.org

More lists of financial resources

- American Veterinary Medical Association (AVMA)
- Best Friends Animal Society
- Banfield Foundation resources for pet owners
- Humane World for Animals (formerly the Humane Society of the United States)
- New York State Veterinary Medical Society
- Paws 4 A Cure's full list of links

- RedRover directory (state, national, condition- and breed-specific programs)
- Speaking for Spot
- Fetch a Cure
- SHHS: help with medical expenses

For low-cost clinics and other local help, see our **Low-Cost & Community Resources** list at spcaonline.com/vet-care.